

under the aegis of composer Zoltán Kodály. Following in the footsteps of Kodály and Bartók, Ligeti adopted a quasi-nationalist, folk-tinged style, largely because he had very limited access to new music from elsewhere in Europe. He graduated in 1949, and went on to teach at the Liszt Academy. That year he also married his first wife, Brigitte, but this ended in divorce three years later, when he married Veronika (known as Vera) Spitz—not a love match, but to prevent her deportation due to her bourgeois background. After Stalin's death in 1954, they felt it was safe to divorce, but remained friends.

Their optimism was short-lived. In 1956, the Hungarian Revolution was brutally quashed by Soviet forces, and Ligeti fled with Vera to Vienna. They then made their way to Cologne, where Ligeti was offered work with Karlheinz Stockhausen in the Electronic Music Studio, and he and Vera remarried, this time in earnest.

In Cologne he had his first real contact with current trends in music, and slowly learned to absorb these into his own compositions. One of his most productive periods was during the 1960s, when he wrote many of his best-known pieces (and achieving some popularity through their use in films by Stanley Kubrick), including *Atmosphères*, the *Requiem*, *Lux aeterna*, *Lontano*, and the Absurdist theatrical pieces *Aventures* and *Nouvelles Aventures*, which showed his darkly humorous side.

He and Vera had a son, Lukas, in 1965, and Ligeti took Austrian citizenship in 1968. By this time, his reputation had been secured and his music was being performed worldwide. After a brief period in the US, he was appointed professor of